

Qualification Programme
Module 4 – Business Management
Report on Candidates' Performance
(June 2024 Session)

(The main purpose of the following report is to summarise candidates' common weaknesses and make recommendations to help future candidates improve their performance in the examination.)

This paper consisted of 45 multiple-choice questions. Candidates had one hour and forty-five minutes to complete the paper. The questions of this paper related broadly to the following Principal Learning Outcomes:

- (a) Describe the types and characteristics of business entities
- (b) Explain the importance of effective organisational management
- (c) Explain the role of production and operations management
- (d) Explain the importance of management in a service entity
- (e) Explain the role of financial management
- (f) Explain the role of human resource management
- (g) Describe and analyse effective control systems
- (h) Explain and apply basic concepts of marketing
- (i) Describe the characteristics of international business and features of globalisation

The multiple-choice questions in this paper were divided into two broad categories, which were worth 1 to 2 marks each:

- Knowledge-based questions; and
- Application-based questions.

General Comments

The average marks (in percentage) scored by candidates for questions of the topic areas are as follows:

(a) Describe the types and characteristics of business entities	75.6%
(b) Explain the importance of effective organisational management	66.2%
(c) Explain the role of production and operations management	64.9%
(d) Explain the importance of management in a service entity	62.9%
(e) Explain the role of financial management	47.8%
(f) Explain the role of human resource management	70.6%
(g) Describe and analyse effective control systems	67.7%
(h) Explain and apply basic concepts of marketing	58.0%
(i) Describe the characteristics of international business and features of globalisation	69.1%

The average marks (in percentage) scored by candidates for the two broad categories of questions are as follows:

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|-------------------------------|-------|
| • Knowledge-based questions | 61.4% |
| • Application-based questions | 65.7% |

In general, the candidates' performance in this session was satisfactory. Candidates exhibited competence in describing the types and characteristics of business entities, explaining the importance of effective organisational management, explaining the role of production and operations management, explaining the role of human resource management, describing and analysing effective control systems, and describing the characteristics of international business and features of globalisation. However, their proficiency in explaining the importance of management in a service entity, explaining the role of financial management, and explaining and applying basic concepts of marketing was relatively weaker.

Specific Comments

In this session, candidates demonstrated weakest performance in questions covering the following topics:

- Explain the importance of service quality
- Describe the short- and long-term financial requirements of a business entity
- Describe and analyse the characteristics of effective control systems including performance control in entities
- Explain and apply key elements of marketing mix:
 - Product
 - Price
 - Place
 - Promotion
- Describe the features of globalisation including the role of multi-national corporations (MNCs), international trade, e-commerce and emerging markets

Specifically, candidates encountered difficulties with the specialised topics of explaining the role of the accounting function in relation to financial analysis, reporting and control, describing and analysing the characteristics of effective control systems, explaining and applying key element of marketing mix: promotion, and describing the features of globalisation. It appears that candidates may not have prepared sufficiently for these topics.

Additionally, candidates should thoroughly consider the context of the question and its requirements, grasp the related conceptual theories, and effectively apply them when responding to application-based questions. To ensure a comprehensive understanding of how to approach multiple-choice questions, candidates are encouraged to study the [Tips for Answering Multiple Choice Questions](#) available on the HKICPA website.